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GRAND SPECTACLE



World No. 1 **Carlos Alcaraz** became the youngest ever to complete the career Grand Slam by winning his first Australian Open title.



Paul Fein

Each of the top four seeds in the men's draw sought to make tennis history. Carlos Alcaraz (**above**) went so far as to declare he'd rather win this Australian Open than all three of the other Major titles this year. If he achieved his goal, he'd not only join eight other immortals with a men's career Grand Slam but stand above them in the tennis pantheon as the youngest at 22 years old.

Novak Djokovic was already acclaimed as the GOAT among the men with 24 Major crowns and an Olympic gold medal when, in 2024 at Paris, he defeated Alcaraz, no less at age 37. A 25th Grand Slam title in Melbourne would have broken his tie with Margaret Court.

As former No. 1 Courier put it, "Novak doesn't need this title, but he wants it." In truth, he wanted it badly, as even ageless champions do, because they're great competitors and they relish challenges — even Sisyphean challenges. Remember an ailing, over-the-hill, 38-year-old Muhammad

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